OUR GROUP'S READING

WHO HOLDS THE PAINTBRUSH?

Animal Farm is usually read as the Russian Revolution in disguise. We think it is also about something simpler: **the pigs win by controlling what is written down**, so the other animals end up doubting their own memories.



HOW IT HAPPENS, IN FOUR STEPS →

1 THE PROMISE · CH. II

SEVEN RULES ON THE BARN WALL

1. Whatever goes upon two legs is an enemy.
2. Whatever goes upon four legs, or has wings, is a friend.
3. No animal shall wear clothes.
4. No animal shall sleep in a bed with sheets.
5. No animal shall drink alcohol to excess.
6. No animal shall kill any other animal without cause.
7. ~~All animals are equal.~~

By Ch. X only one rule is left: ALL ANIMALS ARE EQUAL BUT SOME ANIMALS ARE MORE EQUAL THAN OTHERS

Red words = added later by the pigs, each time they broke a rule.

IN SIMPLE TERMS

The rules the animals fought for were quietly rewritten to suit the pigs.

2 THE WEAKNESS

MOST ANIMALS CAN'T READ WELL

PIGS — *read and write perfectly*

BENJAMIN — *reads well, but says nothing*

MURIEL — *reads a little*

CLOVER — *knows letters, not words*

BOXER — *never gets past D*

SHEEP — *only learn a slogan*

IN SIMPLE TERMS

If you can't read the rules, you can't tell when someone changes them.

3 THE TRICK · CH. VI

"IS IT WRITTEN DOWN?"

> *"Is it written down anywhere?"*
>
> SQUEALER, WHEN THE ANIMALS REMEMBER A RULE

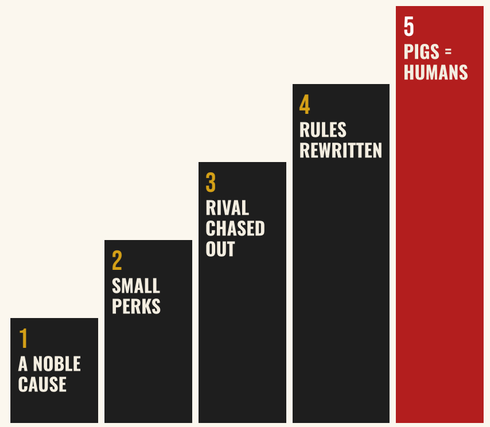
The animals remember a rule against trading with humans. It was never written down, so Squealer convinces them they **dreamed it**. When something *is* written down, the pigs simply repaint it.

IN SIMPLE TERMS

No record means "it never happened". A changed record means "you remembered it wrong".

4 THE RESULT · CH. X

POWER GROWS STEP BY STEP



At the end the animals look from pig to man and **can't tell them apart**.

IN SIMPLE TERMS

No single step looked like a takeover, so nobody stopped it.

OUR MESSAGE: WHOEVER CONTROLS THE RECORD CONTROLS THE PAST.

Read it for the Commandments, not just the Revolution.

GROUP MEMBERS

SAYANJEET · SAUNAK · RISHABH · YASH · VAIBHAV · RAKTIM

SOURCES

George Orwell, *Animal Farm: A Fairy Story*. London: Secker & Warburg, 1945 (all quotations). Group members' readings; Sayanjeet's review and its 34 classmate responses (2026).